

LEE SER MING MARK

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Deputy Director and Lead Research Specialist (Evaluation) at Singapore's Ministry of Education, where I lead the ministry's evaluation unit across pre-school, general education, and special educational needs. Over 13 years I have led or supported 80+ evaluations of national curricula, policies, and programmes, built the ministry's evaluation system and capability, and published on evaluation practice in Asian educational contexts. I hold a Master's in Program Evaluation and Organizational Behavior from Claremont Graduate University. My research interests centre on policy evaluation methodology, implementation science, and the emerging potential of computational simulation for pre-implementation policy analysis.

PUBLICATION

Lee, S. M. M., & Liu, W. C. (2024). Programme evaluation in action: Theory to practice from an Asian educational context. *Asia Pacific Journal of Education*, 44(3), 569–581.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/02188791.2024.2355306>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Educational Research Association of Singapore (ERAS) Conference 2023: "Programme evaluation in action: Theory to practice in a non-Western educational context."
- National Institute of Education (NIE) Special Interest Group, May 2022: "How MOE uses evaluation to improve programme implementation and effectiveness."

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Deputy Director & Lead Research Specialist (Evaluation)

Ministry of Education, Singapore • April 2021 – Present

- Lead the ministry's evaluation unit, conducting and supporting strategic and systemic evaluation of national education policies and programmes.
- Led organisational development efforts to design and implement ministry-wide evaluation policy and guidelines.
- Conduct training workshops and develop evaluation resources including the MOE Evaluation Portal and an AI-powered evaluation support agent.
- Awarded National Day Award — Public Administration Medal (Bronze), 2025.

Head / Senior / Assistant Director (Evaluation)

Ministry of Education, Singapore • January 2012 – March 2021

- Led teams to conduct, co-conduct, or provide evaluation consultancy to 80+ education-related projects encompassing pre-school, general education, and special educational needs.
- Facilitated and developed theories of change and logic models; planned and implemented monitoring and evaluation across diverse policy contexts.

Psychological Researcher

Ministry of Education, Singapore • September 2006 – July 2010

- Conducted psychological research for educational purposes and contributed to educational test development.

EDUCATION

Master of Program Evaluation & Organizational Behavior

Claremont Graduate University • 2010 – 2021 • GPA 3.809

Coursework included: Comparative Evaluation Theory, Professional Practice of Evaluation, Organizational Development and Change, Applied Multiple Regression, Structural Equation Modeling.

Bachelor of Social Sciences in Psychology (Honours)

RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL INTERESTS

My primary research interest is in policy evaluation methodology — specifically, how new computational tools can complement existing pre-implementation evaluation approaches. In my own time, I have been exploring the intersection of LLMs and agent-based tools:

- Replicated Ghaffarzadegan et al.'s (2024) generative agent-based modelling (GABM) code and adapted it for a school policy context, simulating interactions among a principal, a middle manager, and a teacher responding to a policy directive. This was an early exploratory prototype prior to the availability of platforms such as MiroFish.
- Independently explored LLM fine-tuning (LoRA) and local model deployment using open-source tools (Ollama, LM Studio) on personal hardware.
- Built working Telegram bots powered by LLM agents as personal projects, gaining practical experience with agent architectures, API integration, and prompt engineering.

This hands-on exploration, while informal, directly motivated the thesis proposal and gave me practical familiarity with the tools and workflows the research will employ.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Languages:** English and Chinese.
- **Award:** MOE Postgraduate Scholarship (PGS) for PhD candidature.